ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** a girl called simple proves wise and brave	Label versus reality.
2	**(d)** it creates suspense and a strong climax	Suspense.
3	**(c)** education changes individuals who then challenge custom	Link.
4	**(c)** criticise social prejudice and dowry while praising education	Social purpose.
5	**(a)** he represents only greed	Flat character.
6	**(d)** she feared that her daughter would remain unmarried	Implied.
7	**(d)** an act of assertion and truth-telling	Symbolic.
8	**(b)** Where there is a will there is a way	Willpower.
9	**(b)** dignity	Dignity.
10	**(d)** it exposes social attitudes to girls and dowry	Social critique.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Education and a kind teacher can build confidence (1) though the speed of change is compressed for the story's effect (1).	1+1
12	She was sent because she seemed unlikely to marry (1) yet schooling gave her the very strength to reject marriage on her terms (1).	1+1
13	It reduces her to a trait (1) and shapes how others treat her until she disproves it (1).	1+1
14	It shows a girl proving her worth (1) and rejecting a marriage arranged as a bargain (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Realistic details of village life and prejudice give force. The transformation of Bholi and the ending are idealistic. The mix gives hope without ignoring injustice.	1+1+1
16	Both change through someone's kindness. Hari's change is moral and private; Bholi's is social and public. Both show the power of trust and education.	1+1+1
17	The title is a label of weakness. The final scene gives strength and dignity. The reader leaves with a sense of triumph over prejudice.	1+1+1
	OR: The neglected child receives schooling. The 'simple' girl is the wisest. The groom who seeks gain loses a bride. Irony drives the story.	1+1+1
18	He did not give enough care or hope for her. Yet he followed social norms and was anxious. His responsibility is limited but real.	1+1+1
	OR: The demand is the occasion. The cause is her new confidence and sense of worth. The demand brings her inner strength out.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Define empowerment (1). Before school (1). Teacher and learning (1). The climax and decision (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Qualities (1). Impact on Bholi (1). Patience (1). Modern relevance (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Plot of one girl (1). Dowry critique (1). Suspense at wedding (1). Irony (1). Overall effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Social worker's request (1). Bholi's experience (1). Plan (1). Agreement (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Bholi an educated girl at the start; she is a **shy, slow girl who stammers**, pock-marked from smallpox, whose real name is **Sulekha**.
- Saying her parents sent her to school gladly; they did so because she was unlikely to be married and school was a *last resort*.
- Giving the wrong reason for refusal: she rejected the groom **Bishamber** because he demanded dowry and was lame, not out of anger.
- Forgetting the teacher: her **kindness** gave Bholi confidence and led to her transformation.
- Mixing the end: Bholi chooses to remain unmarried, **stay and teach** in the village school, and look after her parents.
- Spelling slips: *Bholi, Sulekha, Bishamber, dowry, stammer, Ramlal*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** was the final humiliation that triggered Bholi's refusal	Idiom.
2	**(c)** Unless society changes its attitude, daughters will remain a burden.	Correct conditional.
3	**(b)** recognition and respect can come from outside the family	Contrast.
4	**(a)** she lacked confidence before school	Lack of empowerment.
5	**(c)** limitless possibilities for educated girls	Possibility.
6	**(a)** Bholi's change is rapid and everything works out	Critique.
7	**(b)** simple plot with a strong moral shift	Simplicity.
8	**(a)** the greedy groom is rejected and shamed	Justice.
9	**(b)** it protects her dignity and challenges social custom	Dual significance.
10	**(c)** that a bride is a burden to be compensated	Assumption.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He sets the teacher's respect against the family's scorn (1) and the groom's greed against Bholi's dignity (1).	1+1
12	It is a public arena where social custom is performed (1) so her refusal confronts society itself (1).	1+1
13	The wedding stands for convention and public approval (1) and refusing there shows truth and assertion (1).	1+1
14	It offers a single heroic case rather than systematic change (1) and relies on one kind teacher, which may be idealised (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The village labels and pressures Bholi but also changes through the school. Guests at the wedding witness her courage. The community is both obstacle and audience.	1+1+1
16	Short firm sentences by Bholi contrast with the groom's demands. The dialogue is plain but powerful. It marks the change in her.	1+1+1
17	She remains in a society with strong prejudices. She chooses a personal solution rather than changing the system. But her act encourages others.	1+1+1
	OR: Bholi's confidence arises from education. Her act challenges the dowry custom in public. Individual courage can start social change.	1+1+1
18	The groom values dowry; the father values social approval; the teacher values the child. Bholi learns to value herself. The story contrasts true and false values.	1+1+1
	OR: Words like 'burden' and the focus on marriage show prejudice. Girls' worth is tied to marriage. The story challenges this view.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Meaning and history (1). Harms (1). Bholi's example (1). Solutions (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Hope in education (1). Individual courage (1). Limits of single act (1). Role of society (1). Verdict (1).	2+2+1
20	Bholi's adversity: birth and prejudice (1). Mathilde's: self-created debt (1). Bholi's growth through education (1). Mathilde's through toil (1). Verdict (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). Daily work as teacher (1). Memories (1). Her students (1). Reflection (1).	2+2+1

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Bholi said that she would not marry that greedy man.	Backshift.
2	**(a)** contrast of early and later scenes	Contrast.
3	**(d)** her actions at the wedding	Show rather than tell.
4	**(b)** show how custom pressures individuals	Context.
5	**(d)** a catalyst for change	Catalyst.
6	**(b)** critical	Critical.
7	**(d)** To what extent does the story offer a realistic solution to dowry?	Evaluative.
8	**(a)** he is ashamed yet relieved, showing mixed social attitudes	Complex.
9	**(a)** to gain the confidence to express oneself	Idiom.
10	**(d)** the capacity to act and decide for oneself	Agency.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It shows loyalty and maturity (1) but it is her free choice, not an obligation, which preserves her independence (1).	1+1
12	The order only sent her to school (1) but kindness changed her inner life (1).	1+1
13	Bholi gives up the security of marriage (1) to keep her dignity, valuing self-respect above comfort (1).	1+1
14	At first he is anxious and conformist (1) at the end he is humbled and begins to see her worth (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The stammer symbolises a silenced voice. Its disappearance signals her empowerment. At the climax she speaks clearly and firmly.	1+1+1
16	Bholi, who was timid, became bold after she went to school. A relative clause and a subordinate clause combine them.	1+1+1
17	It is simple, moving and teaches values of courage and equality. It deals with social issues in age-appropriate ways. It is thus suitable and valuable.	1+1+1
	OR: Teachers should treat every child with respect and patience. A teacher can reshape a life by faith. The story honours such teachers.	1+1+1
18	Ramlal was insulted by the groom's family. The passive keeps focus on Ramlal's humiliation.	1+1+1
	OR: She sees duty as care for parents, not obedience to custom. She chooses what she thinks right. Duty becomes an act of freedom.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Opening with misfortune (1). School as turning point (1). Marriage plot (1). Climax (1). Resolution (1).	2+2+1
	OR: School (1). Stammer (1). Wedding (1). How they connect (1). Overall effect (1).	2+2+1
20	Greeting (1). Bholi's story (1). Importance of girls' education (1). Barriers to overcome (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Setting (1). Problem (1). Helper (1). Climax (1). Resolution (1).	2+2+1

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